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NEWS

Inglewood ICE activists

Push for protections ahead of World Cup

By LaMonica Peters | The LA Local

Published April 18, 2026 10:06 AM

A coalition of community activists and supporters held a vigil Thursday evening near the Home Depot on Century Boulevard to acknowledge those who were detained by masked agents earlier this year.

(LaMonica Peters / The LA Local)

Topline:

A coalition of community activists and supporters held a vigil Thursday evening near the Home Depot on Century Boulevard to acknowledge those who were detained by masked agents earlier this year.

The background: The vigil was organized by ING Fellowship, a grassroots organization founded in 2018 to address issues affecting Inglewood residents, where about 25 people gathered in the parking lot with flowers, candles and signs that read, “Boycott Home Depot” and “Inglewood Unidos.”

Why now: The event was part of the group’s week of action to demand stronger protections for immigrant families and more accountability from city leaders in the wake

of ongoing federal immigration enforcement.

Read on ... for more on the push for immigrant protections ahead of the World Cup.

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HOUSING & HOMELESSNESS

Fed homelessness report

The federal point-in-time count is months overdue

By Marisa Kendall | CalMatters

Published May 13, 2026 3:46 PM



Henry Wilkinson and Kristina Ross record a makeshift shelter during LAHSA's homeless count Jan. 20.
(Jordan Rynning / LAist)

Topline:

Every December, the federal government releases a report that reveals the number of homeless residents in each state and across the country. It's now May and the report, which compiles data from a homeless census known as the "point-in-time count," is nowhere to be found.

Point in time count: For the past two decades, the federal Department of Housing and Urban Development has required local regions to take a census of their homeless populations every other year in a massive undertaking called the point-in-time count. Volunteers go out on foot over a day or two in January and count every person they see living outside. People sleeping in shelters are tallied as well. Counters also conduct surveys of a sample of unhoused people, collecting extra data on people's race, age, gender, time spent homeless, medical and mental health conditions, and more. Each jurisdiction must submit their count to HUD by the spring. They also release their local data to the public. Meanwhile, HUD verifies the data, tallies the total count for each state and for the country as a whole, submits a public report to Congress and uploads more detailed data on its website.

Why it matters: While there's no legal deadline, that report usually comes out in December of the year of the count. It's unclear why the 2025 report still isn't out. The delay is a problem because the report dictates how funding is allocated in California and beyond. It also shapes policy decisions and provides the country's main barometer for how the homelessness crisis is being managed. The five-month delay is leaving public officials, policymakers and advocates scratching their heads. California has filled the gap by tallying its own data, showing a 9% drop in the number of people sleeping outside. But unlike the official federal report, California's analysis leaves out information such as the race, age and mental health status of the people who are counted. And without the full federal report, there's no way to tell where California stands compared to other states.

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NEWS

Olympic wage change?

Council considers delaying wage increases

Libby Rainey is a general assignment reporter. She covers the news that shapes Los Angeles and how people change the city in return.

Published May 13, 2026 3:31 PM



Los Angeles City Council President Marqueece Harris-Dawson introduced the motion to delay minimum wage increases for tourism workers.

(Samanta Helou Hernandez / LAist)

Topline:

The Los Angeles City Council is moving forward with a contentious plan to roll back minimum wage increases for tourism workers, as the city faces the looming prospect of a measure to repeal the business tax that could financially ruin the city landing on the November ballot.

The context: The move, approved in a 10-5 vote Wednesday, is an about-face for the council, which voted just last year to increase the minimum wage for airport and hotel workers in the city to \$30 an hour by 2028. Now, the council is considering a plan to delay that boost until 2030, slowing down the pace of annual increases to the minimum wage.

Why has the council shifted its position? City leaders are hoping to stave off a tax repeal that would slash the city budget and lead to major cuts and lay-offs. Business leaders behind that ballot initiative garnered enough signatures to get it placed on the ballot, but could still withdraw it. They've indicated that they might if the council delays minimum wage boosts.

What are city councilmembers saying? Council President Marqueece Harris-Dawson said Wednesday the city was in ongoing discussions with labor and business leaders to broker a compromise, and that he expected that the proposal the council was considering would change as those discussions continue.

Keep reading ... for the history of the battle over wages for tourism workers in Los Angeles.

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NEWS

Military family

A look at one family's life as Iran war continues

By Juliana Kim | NPR

Published May 13, 2026 3:30 PM



(Stella Kalinina for NPR)

Topline:

Military life has always involved some degree of uncertainty. But for many families, the war in Iran is the first time they are navigating the fear and unknowns that come with having a loved one deployed to an ongoing conflict. NPR spent time with the Los Angeles family of an Army reservist and got a close look at how the war — with its bursts of fighting, shaky truce and slow-moving peace talks — has reshaped life at home thousands of miles away.

A family's life on pause: Jessica Serrato's partner is expected to return to Los Angeles this summer but she's skeptical. His return date has already been delayed a month. — meaning he'll miss Laylah's birthday. About 50,000 American troops are currently deployed across the Middle East as hostilities between the U.S. and Iran grind into a third month. The two nations are once again at an impasse — with President Trump on Monday calling Iran's latest demands "garbage" and warning that the ceasefire was on "massive life support."

Being deployed on short notice: A unique aspect to the current conflict is that many service members are being deployed on short notice, according to Shannon Razsadin, the CEO of the Military Family Advisory Network. A monthslong deployment typically requires a lot of prep work for military families, such as managing finances and arranging child care. During the wars in Iraq and Afghanistan, Razsadin said most families had months to prepare. But under Operation Epic Fury, many service members were sent off in a matter of days. Serrato's partner had a few months' notice before he left. But for families of National Guard members or reservists, deployments can be especially challenging because they often don't live near or on military bases — as in Serrato's case — making it harder to access resources and support networks.

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EXPLORE LA

747 in Exposition Park?

Museum expansion edges closer to an opening date

[Makenna Cramer](#) has been covering space shuttle Endeavour's journey at the California Science Center for nearly three years.

Published May 13, 2026 1:51 PM



Guests will be able to walk around the outside and inside of part of a Boeing 747-400, including the cockpit.
(Courtesy California Science Center)

Topline:

The California Science Center has installed the first of more than a dozen aircraft in the museum's 200,000-square-foot expansion coming to Exposition Park.

Why now: As of this week, the front portion of a Boeing 747-400 towers over the ground floor of the Korean Air Aviation Gallery, one of three main spaces in the Samuel Oschin Air and Space Center.

Why it matters: Once open to the public, the center will be the only place in the world to see an authentic space shuttle in its “Go for Stack” position, which is what officials called the months-long process of moving each component into place, according to the museum.

The backstory: The new center, which recently completed construction, is built around a towering centerpiece: space shuttle Endeavour in its 20-story vertical launch position.

What's next: Jeffrey Rudolph, president and CEO of the California Science Center, said museum officials are working to announce an opening date for the center within the next several weeks.

Go deeper: [The Final Lift For Space Shuttle Endeavour's 'Go For Stack' Mission](#)

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